FROM JEWELRY TO BUSINESS

BONUS 7



From Jewelry to Your Own Small Business

A calm, practical plan for turning your beaded pieces into a small shop, one step at a time

You do not need a business degree, a big budget, or a spare room to start selling beaded jewelry. You need a handful of pieces you are proud of, a few kind people to show them to, and a simple plan you can follow in small pockets of time. That is exactly what this guide gives you.

Everything here is built around the Tiny Bead Profit Method: start small, learn from real customers, and grow only as fast as feels comfortable. Delicate seed-bead pieces are well suited to this approach because the materials are light, inexpensive to store, and easy to ship.

One honest note before we begin. Nobody can promise what a handmade shop will earn. Results depend on your skill, your time, your local market, and plenty of things outside your control. Any prices you see in this guide are examples to help you think, not predictions. Treat this as a practical roadmap, not a guarantee.

1. Chapter 1: Choosing Your Niche (What to Make First)

The biggest beginner mistake is trying to sell everything. A shop with earrings, bracelets, necklaces, keychains, phone charms, and hair clips looks scattered, and it is exhausting to produce. A small, clear focus makes you easier to remember, faster to make, and simpler to photograph.

Your niche is simply a combination of three things: what you make, who it is for, and what it feels like. For example: “delicate peyote earrings in soft neutrals for everyday wear” or “bold loom-woven bracelets in team colors.” You can change it later. The point is to start with a direction.

> **START WITH EARRINGS OR BRACELETS**
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> For most beginners, small items sell and ship more easily than large ones. Earrings are quick to finish, cheap to package, and a natural impulse purchase. Bracelets are slightly bigger but still light. Necklaces and statement pieces take longer, so save them for after your first sales.

Use these four questions to narrow your focus:

- Which stitch do I enjoy most? If you love the rhythm of peyote, lean into peyote. If loom weaving feels relaxing, let that lead.
- Which pieces can I finish in under two hours? Short build times make a small business realistic.
- Who would wear this? Picture one real person, such as a coworker, a teacher, a sister, or a neighbor, and think about their style.
- What occasions already exist? Gifts, seasonal events, school colors, holidays, weddings, and team spirit all create built-in demand.

Next, choose a color story. Two or three palettes are plenty to start. A neutral palette (cream, taupe, gold), a bright palette (coral, turquoise, sunny yellow), and a seasonal palette (autumn rust, winter silver and blue) cover a lot of ground. Fewer palettes means fewer beads to buy and a more consistent look.

Do not worry about being original in a grand sense. Most successful small shops are built on familiar shapes done well: a clean hoop, a tidy fringe, a well-balanced cuff. What makes them yours is the color sense, the finishing, and the care. Spend your early energy on making a few things beautifully rather than inventing something entirely new.

Practice task: Write your niche sentence

Fill in this sentence and keep it where you can see it: “I make [type of piece] in [style or colors] for [type of person or occasion].” Then list three things you will not make for the first 60 days. Saying no early protects your time.

2. Chapter 2: Your Starter Collection of 12 Pieces

Before you sell anything, build a small starter collection. Twelve pieces is a good number: enough to fill a display and look like a real shop, but small enough to finish in a few weeks of relaxed beading. Quality matters more than quantity, so only include pieces you would happily wear or gift yourself.

Think in terms of a mini range with variety in price and effort. Here is one sample layout you can adapt to your own niche:

Group	Pieces	Idea
Quick sellers	4 pairs of earrings	Simple peyote drops or fringe in two palettes, easy to wear and easy to gift
Mid-range	4 bracelets	Two loom-woven cuffs and two peyote or brick-stitch bands with clasps
Gift items	2 sets	Matching earrings plus bracelet in the same colors, presented together
Statement pieces	2 items	A pendant or wider cuff that shows off your best skills and draws attention at a table

Repeat colors and shapes across the collection so everything looks like it belongs together. When a customer sees three pieces in one palette, they imagine wearing the whole look and are more likely to buy two items instead of one.

> **MAKE A SMALL BATCH, NOT A MOUNTAIN**
> Do not buy huge quantities of beads before you know what sells. Buy for your 12 pieces, plus a little extra of your most-used colors. You can reorder once you see which designs people ask about.

Quality control is the quiet secret of a good shop. Before any piece goes into your collection, check it against a short list:

- Rows are even and tension is firm without being stiff.
- Beads are consistent in size. Set aside any that look too big or misshapen.
- Thread ends are woven in and hidden, with no tails sticking out.
- Clasps, ear wires, and jump rings are closed and secure.
- The piece lies flat or drapes smoothly, with no curling or twisting.
- You would be proud to see it in a stranger's hands.

Keep a simple notes page for each design: the beads and colors used, the thread, the approximate time it took, and what it cost you in materials. This will make pricing, restocking, and custom orders much easier later. If you have been through the Fix-It Guide, you already know how to troubleshoot small problems before they reach a customer.

A note on timing: write down how long each piece actually takes, from first bead to final knot. Beginners often underestimate this by half. Knowing your real time per piece is what lets you plan a fair, sustainable price later, and it keeps you from promising customers dates you cannot meet.

Practice task: Plan your 12

3. Chapter 3: Finding Your First Customers

Your first customers rarely come from strangers on the internet. They come from people who already know you, or who are one step away from someone who does. Start close to home, learn what resonates, and widen the circle gradually.

Here are the most beginner-friendly places, in the order many makers try them:

- Friends and family. Wear your own pieces and mention that you are making more. Ask for honest feedback before you ask for sales. This group will also give you your first photos, first reviews, and first referrals.
- Local groups. Neighborhood pages, community boards, school or hobby groups, and local buy-and-sell groups often welcome handmade items. Read each group's rules first, and only post where selling is allowed.
- Craft fairs and markets. Church bazaars, school fairs, holiday markets, and farmers' market craft tables let people hold your work. Start with small, low-cost events. Chapter 6 covers setup in detail.
- Instagram or another visual platform. Share short posts of works in progress, finished pieces on a plain background, and close-ups of the beadwork. Consistency matters more than perfection. A few posts a week is plenty.
- Etsy or a similar marketplace. A marketplace gives you built-in shoppers but also competition. Fees, rules, and policies change, so check the current terms on the site before you list anything.
- Wholesale or boutique approach. Small gift shops, salons, cafes, and boutiques sometimes carry local handmade jewelry. This can work well once you have a consistent collection, a price list, and professional-looking photos.

> **MARKETPLACE BASICS**
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> On a marketplace, strong listings have clear photos in natural light, a title that says what the piece is (for example, “Beaded Peyote Earrings, Cream and Gold”), accurate dimensions, and honest shipping details. Add a short description of the materials and the care instructions. Always check the current fee structure and seller policies, because these change.

If you try the wholesale or boutique route, keep it simple. Bring three or four sample pieces, a one-page price sheet, and a note about how many you can make per month. Many shops prefer consignment or a small first order, so be ready to discuss both. Pricing details for wholesale vary, so decide on your lowest comfortable price before the conversation and stick to it.

Do not try every channel at once. Choose one or two for your first 30 days. A good starter pairing is friends and family plus one local craft fair, or Instagram plus a local group. Once those feel comfortable, add another.

Whichever channels you choose, be patient with yourself. The first few weeks are about learning, not about numbers. Pay attention to which photos get comments, which pieces people pick up first at a table, and which questions come up again and again. That information is more valuable than any single sale.

Practice task: Pick your two channels

4. Chapter 4: Copy-and-Paste Message Templates

Many makers freeze when it is time to ask for a sale. The solution is to write your messages once and reuse them. Below are ready-to-use templates. Change the words in brackets and adjust the tone to sound like you. None of them need contact details, because people can reply directly to your message.

TEMPLATE 1: DIRECT MESSAGE TO A FRIEND

Hi [Name]! I've been making little beaded earrings and bracelets lately and I'm putting together my first small collection. Would you be open to taking a look? I'd love your honest opinion on the colors, and if anything catches your eye, I'd be happy to make one for you. No pressure at all!

TEMPLATE 2: LOCAL GROUP POST

Hello, neighbors! I'm a local maker who creates handmade beaded jewelry using tiny glass seed beads. I'm starting a small collection of earrings and bracelets in [colors] and would love to share it with the community. Photos are below. If you're interested in a piece, or want something made in your favorite colors, just send me a message here. Thank you for letting me share, and I hope you have a lovely week!

TEMPLATE 3: THANK-YOU CARD

Thank you so much for choosing a handmade piece. Every bead was placed by hand, and I'm so glad it found a new home with you. To keep it looking its best, store it flat, avoid water and strong perfume, and handle it gently. I hope you enjoy wearing it as much as I enjoyed making it. If you'd like to share a photo or a review, it means the world to a small maker. With gratitude, [Your Name], Tiny Bead Studio.

TEMPLATE 4: CUSTOM-ORDER REPLY

Hi [Name], thank you for thinking of me! I'd be happy to make a custom piece. To get started, could you tell me the colors you have in mind, the type of piece (earrings, bracelet, or necklace), the length or size, and when you'd like to have it? Once I know those details I'll send you a price and an estimated finish date. A small deposit holds your spot in my schedule, and I'll explain how that works when I send the quote.

TEMPLATE 5: POLITE FOLLOW-UP

Hi [Name], I just wanted to check in about the [piece]. If you still have it in mind, I'm happy to hold it for a few more days. If it's not quite right, no worries at all. Thank you for taking a look!

TEMPLATE 6: ASKING FOR A REVIEW

Hi [Name], I hope you're enjoying your [piece]! If you have a moment, would you mind leaving a short review or sharing a photo of it in use? Honest feedback helps other shoppers and helps me improve. Thank you so much for supporting a small handmade shop.

A few simple habits make these templates work better. Personalize the first line every time, even if you only change the name and one detail. Reply promptly but not instantly, so you can write a thoughtful answer. And never send the same message to a large group of people individually without making each one feel personal. Keep a note on your phone with your favorite templates so you can paste them in seconds.

Practice task: Make them yours

Rewrite two of the templates in your own voice. Read them out loud. If a sentence sounds stiff or not like you, change it

5. Chapter 5: Packaging and Branding on a Budget

Handmade jewelry is a small, personal purchase, and the unboxing moment is part of what customers remember. You do not need expensive packaging. A consistent, tidy presentation tells people you care.

Start with your brand basics. They can be as simple as a shop name, two or three colors, and one font. Your shop name is Tiny Bead Studio, or choose your own. Use the same colors and wording on your tags, cards, and photos so everything feels connected.

- Earring cards. Small white or kraft cards with holes for the ear wires, printed or hand-stamped with your shop name. Add a tiny sticker on the back.
- Small boxes or bags. Plain white or kraft jewelry boxes, organza bags, or small paper envelopes. Buy in bulk once you know what size you need.
- Tissue and a ribbon. A sheet of tissue paper and a bit of ribbon or twine makes a gift feel finished.
- A tag or card. Include your shop name, the materials, and short care instructions. Leave off contact details if you prefer, and let marketplace messages or in-person conversations handle communication.
- Shipping materials. Padded mailers or small boxes, depending on the piece. Check current postage rates before pricing shipping.

> **KEEP THE COST PER PIECE LOW**
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> Add up the cost of the card, bag, tissue, ribbon, and sticker for one sale. Include that amount in your price. Even a modest packaging cost per order adds up over time, so it should never come out of your pocket silently.

Photography is also part of branding. Use natural daylight near a window, a plain background such as white paper, linen, or wood, and a clean phone lens. Take one wide shot, one close-up, and one showing scale on a hand or ear. Keep editing light so the colors match the real piece, because accurate color reduces returns and disappointment.

Consistency beats cleverness. A simple card, a neat fold of tissue, and a handwritten line of thanks will be remembered long after a fancy but forgettable box. If budget is tight, spend on one thing that customers actually touch, such as a good earring card, and keep the rest minimal.

Practice task: Build a packaging kit

Choose one earring card, one bag or box, one tag, and one ribbon. Package a single finished piece and photograph it. If you would be happy to receive it, you are ready.

6. Chapter 6: Craft-Fair Setup and Pricing Signs

A craft fair is one of the best ways to learn what people actually like. You see reactions in real time, and you meet customers who will remember you. Begin with a small, low-cost event close to home so there is little pressure.

Before the event, confirm the table size, the setup time, whether electricity is available, and what the rules are for payment and permits. Rules differ by event and by location, so ask the organizer.

Category	What to bring
Table and display	Tablecloth, jewelry stands or busts, earring card holders, small trays, a mirror, a few risers for height
Inventory	Your 12-piece collection plus a few extras, packed so nothing tangles
Signs	Shop name sign, price signs, a short “handmade with tiny glass beads” sign
Packaging	Bags, boxes, tissue, tags, a few thank-you cards
Payments	Cash for change, a phone-based card reader if you choose to use one, a notebook or phone app for sales
Comfort	Chair, water, snacks, sunscreen or a jacket, tape, scissors, and a small repair kit with spare thread, needles, and findings

Pricing signs matter. Customers often walk away rather than ask. Use clear, simple price tags or signs, grouped by price. For example, one tray labeled “Earrings $18–$28 (example)” and another labeled “Bracelets $30–$45 (example)”. These are example ranges only. Check what similar handmade pieces list for in your area, and factor in your materials and time.

> **A SIMPLE PRICING FORMULA**
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> Add up materials, packaging, and your time at an hourly rate you feel is fair. Then think about fees and a small buffer. If the number feels high, consider whether you can speed up the design, use fewer beads, or create a simpler version. Never price based only on what you would pay.

- Arrange pieces in groups by color so the table looks tidy.
- Put your best statement pieces at eye level.
- Keep a few items in a lower price range for first-time buyers.
- Smile, say hello, and let people look. Offer a simple line such as “Feel free to try anything on.”
- Write down what people ask for. It is free market research.

Practice task: Do a home rehearsal

Set up your table at home with a cloth, your displays, and your signs. Take a photo, then change one thing and take another. Which looks more inviting? Pack it all into one tote bag to be sure you can carry it.

7. Chapter 7: Custom Orders and Deposits

Custom orders are a wonderful way to earn repeat customers, but they can quickly become stressful if expectations are unclear. A simple process protects both you and your customer.

Follow these steps for every custom request:

- Gather the details. Ask for colors, type of piece, size or length, any special occasion, and the date they need it by.
- Check your schedule. Look at your calendar and give yourself extra time. It is better to deliver early than to rush.
- Quote clearly. Tell the customer the price, what it includes, and how long it will take.
- Request a deposit. A small deposit, often a portion of the price, helps cover materials and confirms that the customer is serious. Decide your policy before you quote and apply it consistently.
- Share a progress photo. For larger pieces, a quick update builds trust and gives the customer a chance to adjust colors.
- Deliver and thank. Send the finished piece with a thank-you card and ask whether they love it.

> **WRITE YOUR POLICY IN PLAIN WORDS**
> Keep a short note for yourself: how much deposit you ask for, what happens if the customer changes their mind, how long you take, and whether custom pieces can be returned. Handmade custom work is often final sale, but check your local rules and be upfront before payment. Share the policy with every customer so there are no surprises.

Set boundaries kindly. If someone requests a design that is beyond your current skill, you can say, “That's a bit outside what I can do beautifully right now, but I could make something similar in this style.” If the timeline is too short, offer a later date or a ready-made alternative. A calm no is better than a stressful yes.

Keep a simple order log with the customer's first name, the details, the date promised, the deposit received, and the date delivered. A notebook or basic spreadsheet is enough.

Finally, remember that you are allowed to decline custom work that does not fit your schedule or your style. A small, focused catalog with a few thoughtful custom options is easier to run than a shop that tries to make anything for anyone. You can always expand your options as your skills and confidence grow.

Practice task: Write your custom-order policy

In five sentences or fewer, write your deposit policy, your standard timeline, and your return policy for custom pieces. Save it where you can copy it into a message.

8. Chapter 8: Reviews and Repeat Customers

A kind review is worth far more than most advertising. It reassures new shoppers and gives you language you can use to describe your work. The best time to ask for one is shortly after the customer has had a chance to enjoy their piece.

- Ask warmly, once. Use the review template from Chapter 4. A gentle request is usually enough.
- Make it easy. Tell people where to leave a review or ask whether you may share their photo.
- Ask permission. Before using a customer's words or photos in your marketing, get their approval.
- Say thank you. Respond to every review, even short ones.
- Handle problems graciously. If something goes wrong, apologize, ask what happened, and offer to repair or replace the piece when you can.

Repeat customers are the foundation of a small shop. They already trust you, they cost nothing to find, and they often tell their friends. Treat them as the most important people in your business.

> **SIMPLE WAYS TO BRING PEOPLE BACK**
>
> Keep a short list of past customers, with their first names and what they bought. A few weeks later, send a friendly note such as “I just finished a new set in colors I think you'd like.” Offer a small thank-you, like a free earring card or a tiny gift, with a second purchase. Remember birthdays and holidays when gift-buying peaks.

Track your best sellers. If three people ask for the same color, make more. If one design never sells, retire it without guilt. Your shop should evolve with real feedback, not guesses.

Finally, treat problems as chances to show care. A customer who receives a quick, kind fix for a loose clasp often becomes a loyal fan. Keep a small repair kit and be generous with simple repairs. Your reputation grows one calm, helpful interaction at a time.

Practice task: Start a customer list

Create a simple list with first name, what they purchased, and one note about their taste. Add to it after every sale. Review it before each season.

9. Chapter 9: Your 5-Hours-a-Week Plan, Plus Legal and Tax Basics

Most makers start while handling work, family, and everything else. A small, repeatable weekly plan keeps the business moving without taking over your life. Five hours a week is a realistic starting point.

Block	Time	What to do
Make	2.5 hours	Bead new pieces from your starter plan, in one or two focused sessions
Photograph and list	1 hour	Take photos in daylight, edit lightly, and write short descriptions
Share and message	1 hour	Post, reply to messages, follow up with customers
Admin	30 minutes	Record sales and expenses, check supplies, plan next week

Batch similar tasks. Photograph several pieces at once, write several posts in one sitting, and prepare packaging in bulk. Protect your beading time as a pleasure, not only a job. If you stop enjoying it, the business becomes harder to sustain.

Now a few legal and tax basics at a high level. This is general information, not legal or tax advice. Rules vary by state and country, so check with your local authority or an accountant.

- Business registration. Some places require a business name registration or a local license even for small home-based sellers. Check your city, county, or state requirements.
- Sales tax. Whether you must collect sales tax can depend on where you sell and how much. Marketplaces may handle some of this, but you should confirm the current rules.
- Income reporting. Income from selling handmade goods is generally reportable. Keep records of sales and expenses, and ask an accountant how to report them where you live.
- Materials safety. If you sell jewelry, use findings made from safe, nickel-conscious materials where possible, and label materials honestly. Some places have rules about metals and children's items.
- Insurance and event rules. Craft fairs may require proof of insurance or a vendor permit. Ask the organizer in advance.

> KEEP RECORDS FROM DAY ONE
>
> Save receipts for beads, tools, packaging, and fees. Write down every sale with the date and amount. This takes minutes each week and saves hours at tax time.

Practice task: Block your five hours

Open your calendar and block five hours for next week in the four categories above. If five hours is too much, start with three and build up.

10. Chapter 10: Your 30-Day Launch Checklist

This final checklist ties everything together. Work through it at your own pace. If you miss a day, simply pick up where you left off. Consistency beats intensity.

Week 1: Foundations

- Write your niche sentence and choose two color palettes.
- Plan your starter collection of 12 pieces.
- Gather the beads, thread, and findings you need, without overbuying.
- Bead your first two pieces and check them against the quality list.
- Choose your shop name and set up a notes page for each design.

Week 2: Build and package

- Finish at least five more pieces.
- Create your packaging kit and package one piece.
- Take photos in natural light, with a wide shot, a close-up, and a scale shot.
- Decide your example price ranges using materials, packaging, and your time.
- Write your custom-order policy.

Week 3: Share

- Finish the remaining pieces so your collection reaches 12.
- Send your friend template to five people.
- Post once in a local group where selling is allowed, or share three photos on your chosen platform.
- Apply for one small craft fair or market, or approach one local shop with a few samples.
- Record your first sale, expenses, and lessons in your notebook.

Week 4: Learn and plan

- Ask each early customer for feedback and, if appropriate, a review.
- Review what sold, what people asked about, and what you enjoyed making most.
- Check your local requirements for registration, tax, and permits.
- Plan your next collection based on what you learned.
- Celebrate. You started.

> **A GENTLE REMINDER**
>
> A small shop grows slowly. Some weeks will be quiet, and that is normal. Keep making things you love, keep improving, and keep showing your work to people who might appreciate it. No results are guaranteed, but steady, thoughtful effort gives you the best chance of building something you are proud of.

Practice task: Pick your launch day

Choose a date 30 days from today and write it at the top of your checklist. Tell one friend about it. A date and a witness make a plan feel real.

Next steps

You now have a complete, beginner-friendly path from a handful of beaded pieces to a small, real shop: a clear niche, a starter collection, first customers, ready-made messages, simple packaging, a craft-fair plan, custom-order rules, review habits, a weekly schedule, and a 30-day checklist.

Next step: open your calendar, block your first five hours, and bead the first piece on your list. Everything else grows from there.

Thank you for being part of Tiny Bead Studio. Wishing you steady progress and plenty of joy at the bead table.